Marathon Training Plan

20 weeks · km and min/km

B.A.A. Level One (beginner)
4 runs a week · 40 → 64 km a week · long runs up to 26–29 km

How to use this plan

1. Choose your goal finish time. Use that column of the pace table.
2. Monday is a rest day every week.
3. Run easy runs truly easy. Most of your running is at this pace.
4. Start every speed session with the warm up. Finish with the warm down.

The four phases

Prep
Weeks 1–3.
Build the habit.

Building
Weeks 4–9.
Add speed and hills.

Marathon specific
Weeks 10–18.
Practise race pace.

Taper
Weeks 19–20.
Run less.
Arrive fresh.

Words used in the plan

Easy run	Conversational or recovery pace.
Aerobic run	About 20–30 s per km faster than easy.
MP	Marathon pace: your goal race pace.
HMP / HM	Half marathon pace.
10K / 5K pace	The pace you could race 10 km or 5 km.
Warm up / down	Easy running before and after hard work.
Hill repeats	Run up a 3–5% slope ("up"), then back down ("down"). Repeat.
Tempo	A steady, sustained effort at the given pace.
Cut-down	Start a little slower. Get faster in stages.
Marathon simulation	Long run with a section at MP, on a rolling, hilly route.
Cross training	Non-running exercise, for example cycling or swimming, or strength work.

Pace table

Goal finish time → Pace in min per km	2:45	3:00	3:15	3:30	3:45	4:00	4:15	4:30	4:45	5:00
5K intervals Very hard. A few words at most.	3:19	3:44	3:59	4:18	4:37	4:55	5:14	5:32	5:51	6:10
10K intervals Hard. Short phrases only.	3:34	3:55	4:14	4:33	4:52	5:11	5:29	5:51	6:28*	6:28
Half marathon pace (HMP) Comfortably hard. Short sentences.	3:44	4:07	4:26	4:46	5:08	5:28	5:47	6:07	6:28	6:47
Marathon pace (MP) Steady. Your race pace.	3:56	4:18	4:40	5:00	5:22	5:44	6:04	6:25	6:47	7:09
Aerobic runs Comfortable but purposeful.	4:15	4:37	4:58	5:23	5:47	6:10	6:33	6:55	7:18	7:43
Easy runs Relaxed. You can talk in full sentences.	4:30	4:54	5:19	5:42	6:07	6:31	6:58	7:15	7:43	8:11

Paces are approximate averages, converted from the B.A.A. pace chart (min per mile). * As published by B.A.A.; this value looks like a typing error, so use about 6:10/km.
Exact marathon pace for a goal time = goal time ÷ 42.195 km. Example: 4:00:00 needs 5:41/km.

Source: Boston Athletic Association (B.A.A.) Level One training plan, baa.org. Converted from miles: 1 mile = 1.609344 km. Distances rounded to 0.1 km, paces to the second.

Weeks 1–10 Monday: rest every week

Easy · Aerobic · Speed / pace work · Long run · Cross training or strength · Rest

Week	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Total
1 Prep	**8.0–9.7 km easy**	Cross or strength	**9.7–11.3 km aerobic**	Cross or strength	**8.0–9.7 km easy**	**9.7–11.3 km aerobic**	**≈ 39** km
2 Prep	**11.3 km aerobic**	Cross or strength	**6.4–8.0 km easy**	Cross or strength	**6.4–8.0 km easy**	**14.5–16.1 km aerobic**	**≈ 41** km
3 Prep	**≈ 8.8–12.1 km hills** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 6 × (200 m up at 10K pace, 30 s rest, 200 m down at MP) · 90 s between sets · 3.2–4.8 km warm down	Cross or strength	**6.4–8.0 km easy**	Cross or strength	**6.4–8.0 km easy**	**14.5–16.1 km aerobic**	**≈ 40** km
4 Building	**9.7–12.9 km intervals** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 4 × 1 km at 10K pace, 2 min rest · 3.2–4.8 km warm down	Cross or strength	**4.8–6.4 km easy**	Cross or strength	**16.1–17.7 km with MP** 4.8 km warm up · 2 × 4.8 km at MP, 2–3 min rest · 1.6–3.2 km warm down	**4.8–6.4 km easy**	**≈ 39** km
5 Building	**11.3–12.9 km hills** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 6 × (300 m up at 10K pace, 30 s rest, 300 m down at MP) · 90 s between sets · 3.2–4.8 km warm down	Cross or strength	**4.8–8.0 km easy**	Cross or strength	**11.3 km with HMP** 3.2 km easy · 6.4 km at HMP · 1.6 km easy	**17.7–19.3 km aerobic**	**≈ 48** km
6 Building	**11.3–12.9 km intervals** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 5 × 1 km at 10K pace, 2 min rest · 1.6–3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	Rest	**11.3 km with HMP** 3.2 km easy · 4.8–6.4 km at HMP · 1.6–3.2 km easy	Cross or strength	**19.3–22.5 km marathon simulation** Rolling hills · 8.0–9.7 km easy · 9.7–11.3 km at MP · 3.2 km easy	**≈ 44** km
7 Building	**11.3–12.9 km hills** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 6 × (300 m up at 10K pace, 45 s rest, 300 m down at MP) · 90 s between sets · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**6.4–9.7 km aerobic**	Cross or strength	**20.9 km with MP** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 4 × 3.2 km at MP, 2–3 min rest · 3.2 km warm down	**6.4–9.7 km easy**	**≈ 49** km
8 Building	**11.3–12.9 km intervals** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 4 × 1200 m at 10K pace, 2 min rest · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**6.4–9.7 km aerobic**	**11.3 km with HMP** 3.2 km easy · 6.4 km at HMP · 1.6 km easy	Cross or strength	**20.9–22.5 km long run** 9.7–12.9 km easy · 8 × (2 min at 10K pace + 2 min at MP) · 3.2 km easy	**≈ 53** km
9 Building	**9.7–11.3 km hills** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 6 × (400 m up at 10K pace, 45 s rest, 400 m down at MP) · 90 s between sets · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**11.3 km with HMP** 3.2 km easy · 6.4 km at HMP · 1.6 km easy	Cross or strength	**6.4–8.0 km easy**	**19.3–20.9 km aerobic**	**≈ 49** km
10 Marathon specific	**12.9–14.5 km intervals** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 5 × 1200 m at 10K pace, 3 min jog · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**6.4–9.7 km aerobic**	Cross or strength	**22.5–24.1 km with MP** 4.8 km warm up · 3 × 4.8 km at MP, 3 min recovery · 1.6–3.2 km warm down	**6.4–8.0 km easy**	**≈ 52** km

Distances are per session. "≈" totals use the middle of each range. Paces: see the pace table on page 1.

Source: Boston Athletic Association (B.A.A.) Level One training plan, baa.org. Converted from miles: 1 mile = 1.609344 km. Distances rounded to 0.1 km, paces to the second.

Weeks 11–20 Monday: rest every week

Easy · Aerobic · Speed / pace work · Long run · Cross training or strength · Rest

Week	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Total
11 Marathon specific	**12.9–14.5 km hills** 3.2 km warm up · 8 × (400 m up at 10K pace, 45 s rest, 400 m down at MP) · 90 s between sets · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**6.4–8.0 km easy**	**11.3 km with HMP** 3.2 km easy · 6.4 km at HMP · 1.6 km easy	Cross or strength	**22.5–24.1 km marathon simulation** Rolling hills · 9.7–11.3 km easy · 9.7 km at MP · 3.2 km easy	≈ 56 km
12 Marathon specific	**11.3–12.9 km intervals** 3.2 km warm up · 4 × 1.6 km at 10K pace, 3 min rest · 1.6–3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**6.4–8.0 km easy**	**11.3–12.9 km with HMP** 1.6–3.2 km warm up · 4.8 km at HMP · 3 min jog · 3.2 km at HMP · 1.6 km warm down	Cross or strength	**22.5–24.1 km aerobic**	≈ 55 km
13 Marathon specific	**12.9–14.5 km hills** 3.2–4.8 km warm up · 8 × (400 m up at 10K pace, 45 s rest, 400 m down at MP) · 90 s between sets · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**8.0–11.3 km aerobic**	Cross or strength	**22.5 km with MP** 3.2 km warm up · 16.1 km at MP: start a little slower, finish faster · 3.2 km warm down	**8.0–9.7 km easy**	≈ 55 km
14 Marathon specific	**11.3–12.9 km intervals** 3.2 km warm up · 4 × 1.6 km at 10K pace, 3 min rest · 1.6–3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**4.8–8.0 km aerobic**	**11.3 km tempo** 3.2 km warm up · 4.8 km tempo at HMP · 1.6 km warm down	Cross or strength	**22.5–27.4 km marathon simulation** Rolling hills · 9.7–12.9 km easy · 9.7–12.9 km at MP · 1.6–3.2 km easy	≈ 55 km
15 Marathon specific	**12.9–14.5 km hills** 3.2 km warm up · 2 × (800 m up at HMP, 60 s rest, 800 m down at MP), 2 min between sets · 4 × (400 m up at 10K pace, 45 s rest, 400 m down at MP), 90 s between sets · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**8.0–11.3 km aerobic**	Cross or strength	**22.5 km with MP** 3.2 km warm up · 2 × 8.0 km at MP, 5 min jog · 3.2 km warm down	**8.0–11.3 km easy**	≈ 56 km
16 Marathon specific	**11.3 km intervals** 3.2 km warm up · 2 × (1.6 km at HMP + 800 m at 5K pace), 2 min rest · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**6.4–8.0 km easy**	**12.9 km cut-down** 3.2 km warm up · 8.0 km at MP: start a little slower, speed up every 3.2 km · 1.6 km warm down	Cross or strength	**19.3–22.5 km easy** Long run at easy pace	≈ 52 km
17 Marathon specific	**12.9 km hills** 3.2 km warm up · 4 × (800 m up at HMP, 60 s rest, 800 m down at MP), 2 min between sets · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	**8.0–11.3 km easy**	**11.3 km tempo** 3.2 km warm up · 6.4 km tempo at HMP · 1.6 km warm down	Cross or strength	**24.1–29.0 km marathon simulation** Rolling hills · 11.3–12.9 km easy · 11.3–12.9 km at MP · 1.6–3.2 km easy	≈ 60 km
18 Marathon specific	**11.3 km intervals** 3.2 km warm up · 2 × (1.6 km at HMP + 800 m at 5K pace), 2 min rest · 3.2 km warm down	Cross or strength	Rest	**9.7–12.9 km aerobic**	Cross or strength	**20.9–22.5 km MP tempo** 4.8 km warm up · 9.7–12.9 km MP tempo · 4.8 km warm down	≈ 44 km
19 Taper	**11.3–12.9 km intervals** 3.2 km warm up · 5 × 1 km at 10K pace, 2 min rest · 3.2 km warm down	**4.8–8.0 km easy**	Rest	**12.9 km with HMP** 3.2 km warm up · 2 × (3.2 km at HMP + 1.6 km easy) · 3.2 km warm down	Rest	**8.0–11.3 km easy**	≈ 41 km
20 Taper	**9.7 km sharpener** 3.2 km warm up · 2 × 800 m at HMP, 90 s rest · 2 × 800 m at 10K pace, 2 min rest · 3.2 km warm down	**3.2–6.4 km easy**	Rest	**8.0 km with MP** 3.2 km warm up · 3.2 km at MP · 1.6 km warm down	Rest	**3.2–4.8 km easy**	≈ 27 km

Distances are per session. "≈" totals use the middle of each range. Paces: see the pace table on page 1. Race day follows week 20.

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